

Zero Conditional

CEFR A2

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

The zero conditional (if + present simple, present simple) is for things that are always true.

Use it for:

- 1 General truths and facts — If you heat ice, it melts.
- 2 Rules, habits and instructions — If the light is red, you stop.

Both clauses use the present simple. You can usually replace 'if' with 'when' — the meaning barely changes.

At a glance

Clause	Verb form	Example
If-clause (the condition)	if + present simple	If you press this button,
Main clause (the result)	present simple	the machine starts .

Learning objectives

- Can form the zero conditional with the present simple in both clauses (CEFR A2).
- Can use it for general truths, rules and habits.
- Can distinguish it from the first conditional.

Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. Zero Conditional · CEFR A2

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. If you heat ice, it ____.

- | | |
|--------------|---------------|
| A. will melt | B. melts |
| C. melted | D. is melting |

2. If I ____ tired, I go to bed early.

- | | |
|--------|-------------|
| A. am | B. will be |
| C. was | D. would be |

3. Water ____ if you cool it to 0°C.

- | | |
|----------------|-------------|
| A. will freeze | B. freezes |
| C. froze | D. freezing |

4. If the traffic light ____ red, cars stop.

- | | |
|--------|------------|
| A. is | B. will be |
| C. was | D. be |

5. If you ____ this button, the machine starts.

- | | |
|---------------|-------------|
| A. will press | B. press |
| C. pressed | D. pressing |

6. If people don't sleep, they ____ tired.

- | | |
|--------------|----------------|
| A. will feel | B. feel |
| C. felt | D. are feeling |

7. If the alarm ____, everyone leaves the building.

- | | |
|----------|--------------|
| A. rings | B. will ring |
| C. rang | D. ringing |

8. ____ you touch fire, you get burned.

- | | |
|---------|----------|
| A. When | B. Will |
| C. Did | D. Would |

9. Rewrite with the same meaning: 'When you touch fire, you get burned.'

- | | |
|---|---|
| A. If you touch fire, you get burned. | B. If you touch fire, you will get burned. |
| C. If you touched fire, you got burned. | D. You get burned when you will touch fire. |

10. Correct this: 'If you will mix red and white, you get pink.'

- | | |
|--|---|
| A. If you mix red and white, you get pink. | B. If you mixed red and white, you got pink. |
| C. If you will mix red and white, you will get pink. | D. When you will mix red and white, you get pink. |

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **B. melts** — A general truth takes the present simple in both clauses: 'it melts'.
2. **A. am** — The if-clause uses the present simple: 'If I am tired'.
3. **B. freezes** — A general truth uses the present simple: 'Water freezes'.
4. **A. is** — The if-clause uses the present simple: 'If the light is red'.
5. **B. press** — The condition uses the present simple: 'If you press'.
6. **B. feel** — A general truth uses the present simple: 'they feel tired'.
7. **A. rings** — The if-clause of a rule takes the present simple: 'If the alarm rings'.
8. **A. When** — In the zero conditional, 'when' and 'if' are almost the same: 'When you touch fire, you get burned'.
9. **A. If you touch fire, you get burned.** — For a general truth, 'when' = 'if', both with the present simple.
10. **A. If you mix red and white, you get pink.** — Both clauses of a zero conditional use the present simple: 'If you mix... you get...'.